

Core Dice Mechanics

Rolling Dice: Roll a **Dice Pool** which consists of an **Attribute** and any relevant bonuses. Any **Successes** (5s or 6s rolled) beyond the **Check** (difficulty) are **Net Successes**.

Dice Roll Results: Just one net success is a **Near Hit**, and victory comes with an unexpected consequence; zero net successes is a **Near Miss**, and failure comes with a small benefit.

Combat Turns

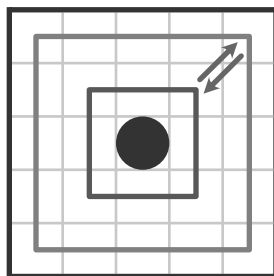
On Your Turn: On your turn in combat, you may **Move**, perform an **Action** (any one dice roll; most often an **Attack**), and freely change the direction you're **Facing**.

Movement

Move from one orthogonal, adjacent square to another. **Diagonal squares are 2 squares apart**. Movement can be split **before and after** an action.

Non-Blades: Move a number of squares per turn equal to your **Movement trait**.

Blades: You can freely move about the squares in your current **Radius** and change radii a number of times equal to your **Movement trait**. **Take -1** in third radius; roll at **half (rounded up)** and move **one square per turn** outside radii.



Distance: If you don't attack, take **double movement**.

Radius Changes: If Bearer moves, choose nearest square in previous radius or **stay in place**, changing radii. If Bearer is moved, **stay in place**.

Facing: You may face any cardinal direction. **Choose a direction** at the end of your turn.

End of Turn Reminders

- ★ Choose Facing.
- ★ If **Blade**, choose a square to stay in.
- ★ Gain a **Special Point** if your basic attack or art hit.
- ★ Turn **Cooldown Dice** 1 lower. 1s turned are removed; art is **ready**.
- ★ Move **Turn Order Token** from top of turn order list to bottom.

Once-Per-Arc Special Abilities

I'm Really Feeling It: Add one **Attribute** to **Initiative** roll, and gain **6 Special Points**.

It's Reyn Time: Guarantee roll success.

The Heronop Special: Turn failed roll into **Near Miss**.

Attacking and Defending

Attack: Name a target within your attack's **Range** (distance in squares) and perform a standard dice roll to attack. **Face** your target; they **Face** you after the attack.

Defend: Standard dice roll to defend. Turn to **Face** attacker.

Basic Attack

Range = **Basic Attack Range** trait. Typically no bonuses. Successful attacks grant one **Special Point**.

Art

Range = **1 + Range +1** Art tags. Target might be an **Area of Effect**. **Potency +1** and **Positional** tags grant bonus dice. Beneficial effects apply regardless of range and success. Arts have **Cooldowns**. Successful attacks grant one **Special Point**.

Special Attack

Range = **anywhere**. Higher levels are **Area of Effect**. Each special increases the **Special Level** of the next one. Expend **Special Level × 6 Special Points** to use. Dice pools use **Ideas**; roll **unopposed**. Applies one **Elemental Effect** from elements aligned with the idea.

Special Attack Levels

- 1: Cost **6**. Target **one enemy**; roll chosen idea; apply one aligned elem. effect.
- 2: Cost **12**. Split damage among any enemies in a **3x3 area**; you and your partner **each roll your chosen idea**; apply one aligned elem. effect to all hit.
- 3: Cost **18**. Split among **5x5 area**; **each choose an idea to roll**; apply one elem. effect from either idea to all hit. **Resets Special Level** to 1.

Party Size Special Attack Rules

- 1 Team:** Specials 1 and 2 do not consume **Special Points**.
- 2 Teams:** One team **receives 6 Special Points** when the other uses a Level 2 Special.
- 3+ Teams:** No changes.

Art Tag Effects

- ★ = has important, complex mechanics
- ▲ = has a beneficial effect with a duration
- ▼ = has a detrimental effect with a duration

Fundamentals

Potency +1 (max 5): +1 to attack.

Healing Potion: One ally heals **net successes**.

Cooldown -1 (max 2): Start cooldown Die 1 lower.

Area of Effect

Circle Attack (max 2): Target all enemies in a 3x3 area; lv. 2 for 5x5 area.

Line Attack: Target all enemies in a **straight line** 5 + Bonus Range long.

Reactions

★ ▼ **Break**: Hit target is **Broken**, vulnerable to **Topple** and **Launch**, until your next turn. Can be extended by whole turn cycles.

★ ▼ **Topple**: Requires and removes **Break**. Target cannot move or attack until your next turn. They can defend, but failed attacks are **Near Hits**. Take an action to un-topple an adjacent ally. **Cannot be extended**.

★ **Launch**: Requires and removes **Break**. Target is pushed **net successes squares** away. Object collision **deals damage = squares from stopping**. Hit combatant takes **damage = squares from stopping**. If no object collision, target moves **back in the turn order** one place.

Stagger: Hit target moves **back in the turn order** one place.

Rush (max 2): Movement +1.

Positionals

Side Advantage (Bearers): Attack from side for +1.

Rear Advantage (Bearers): Attack from behind for +2.

Pincer Attack (Blades): Gain +2 against target in lower radius.

Elemental Effects

Using one requires appropriate **Elemental Affinity**. Pick one of these for **every Special Attack**. Maximum **effect duration** is 6.

★ **Unique Elemental Effect**: choose any one effect corresponding to one of your affinities:

▼ **Fire** (Burning Blade): Target takes 1 damage per turn for **net successes turns**.

▼ **Water** (Arts Seal): Target **cannot use arts** and **do not lower cooldowns** on their next turn.

▲ **Wind** (Blustering Gale): Ally gets +1 defense for **net successes turns**.

▼ **Ice** (Freezing Force): Target **cannot move** next turn. Frozen Bearer = Blade **cannot change radii**.

▲ **Earth** (Cradling Earth): Ally removes and blocks **all detrimental effects** until your next turn.

Electricity (Electrifying Burst): Target moves **back in the turn order** or ally moves **forward in the turn order** one place.

▲ **Light** (Blade of Light): Ally Bearer gains +2 range for **net successes turns**, or ally Blade moves **freely among all radii with no penalties** during their next turn.

▼ **Dark** (Shadow Manipulation): **Redirect enemy attacks** to chosen ally for **net successes turns**.

Invigorating Steam (bravery, fire or water): One ally uses **one art one turn sooner**.

▼ **Bitter Snowstorm** (truth, wind or ice): Target takes -1 movement (min 0) and **attack range** (min 1) for **net successes turns**.

▲ **Counter Spike** (compassion, earth or electricity): Anyone who attacks you **takes 1 damage back** for **net successes turns**.

▼ **Blinding Eclipse** (justice, light or dark): Target takes -1 to **attack and defense rolls** until **after** your next turn.

Other Tags

Precise Attack: Detrimental effects **do not hit allies**.

Range +1 (max 5): +1 attack range.

Blades of Ether

Blades of Ether by Alexis Eva, Kaylee Maya, and Ruby Soleil-Raine. For more information: gears.link/blades